

James Thompson

+64 2102393449 • 1jamesthompson1@gmail.com
in james-thompson-532246208 • 1jamesthompson1
1jamesthompson1

Education

Victoria University of Wellington <i>Master of Artificial Intelligence, Tracking an A+ average</i> Coursework and Research	Wellington, New Zealand <i>Feb 2025 – Feb 2026</i>
Massey University <i>BSc in Computer Science, 94% A+</i> Minoring in Statistics and Mathematics	Extramural, New Zealand <i>2021 – 2023</i>
Hutt Valley High School <i>NCEA Level 3 , Merit Endorsed</i>	Lower Hutt, New Zealand <i>2020</i>

Work Experience and Projects

Transport Accident Investigation Commission

Data Scientist *July 2023 – Current*
This project started as my final semester Computer Science project. I built an engine that uses Large Language Models to analyze published accident investigation reports and implemented a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) architecture for a smart search engine. From November 2023 to December 2024, I worked directly with TAIC to further develop this project. I have now moved into a maintenance role while pursuing further studies. **Project source code:** <https://github.com/1jamesthompson1/TAIC-report-summary>

Victoria University of Wellington

Reinforcement Learning project *February 2025 – June 2025*
This was a single semester research project as part of my Master's program. I worked independently (under supervision) to develop a novel Reinforcement Learning algorithm for continuous robotic control tasks. My algorithm idea was a blend of SAC and dynamic ensemble methods. Ultimately the algorithm was not as successful as I had hoped, but I learned a lot about research process and long running (> week) computer experiments. **The write up can be found here:** https://github.com/1jamesthompson1/AIML440_report/blob/main/output/JamesThompsonAIML440Report.pdf

Self-employed

Freelance Developer and Data Scientist *April 2023 – Current*
I work part-time on contract and freelance IT projects. My work includes developing business administration systems, such as a pupil attendance and invoicing system for a music school, and conducting data science projects like analyzing trends in health insurance claims.

Massey University

Teaching Assistant *February 2023 – November 2023*
During my final year of undergraduate studies, I worked as a teaching assistant in Computer Science and Statistics courses. My responsibilities included grading assignments and tests, as well as providing one-on-one tutoring.

Telefund NZ

Telefundraiser / Developer *April 2021 – August 2023*
I started as a tele-fundraiser and later transitioned into an administrative role. I developed an automated system to streamline administrative responsibilities and assist other callers and administrators.

Extra-Curricular

Summer Research Massey 2022/2023.....

Project: Worked with Dr. J Godfrey on the BrailleR package to enhance accessibility for vision-impaired users. Focused on:

- Expanded the graph explainer to include more ggplot2 graph types.
- Working with Diagcess (JS library) to create interactive webpages for blind users to explore ggplot graphs through a keyboard and sound interface

Competitive Snowboarding.....

Experience: I have been competing in Freeride Snowboarding since age 12, traveling overseas to compete with northern hemisphere athletes.

Highlights and achievements:

- Currently ranked 34st on the Global seeding list
- Won the 2025 Winter Games NZ North Face Frontier 4* event (held in August 2024)
- Competed at the Freeride Junior World Championship in 2020 (Austria) and 2021 (Switzerland).
- Qualified level 2 instructor with Snowboard Instruction New Zealand.

Scholarships and Awards

2025: Wellington Graduate Award, Victoria University

2023: Massey University Scholar Award

2023: Massey University Undergraduate Excellence Scholarship

2022: Massey School of Mathematical and Computational Sciences Summer Scholarship

2022: Massey University Elite Sports Bursary

2021: Massey University Academy of Sports Scholarship

2020: Upper Hutt Cosmopolitan Kickstart Career Scholarship

2020: Hutt Valley High School David Kaye Excellence Award

2019: Hutt Valley High School Best Senior Debater Award